

BEWARE OF SHOPPING SCAMS		
Scam Type	Warning Signs	Prevention Tips
Counterfeit Products	Unrealistic discounts, poor reviews, no brand verification.	Purchase from official stores or verified sellers.
Fake Shopping Websites	Poor website design, HTTP (not HTTPS) URLs, misspelt URLs.	Verify website authenticity before entering personal or payment information.
Phishing Emails & Ads	Urgent calls to action, requests for personal information.	Never click on suspicious links; verify offers directly through official sites.
Auction Site Scams	Sellers requesting payment outside the platform, no buyer protection.	Always complete transactions within the platform to ensure protection.
Gift Card Scams	Sellers asking for payment in gift cards for goods or services.	Be sceptical of any request for gift card payments; report suspicious requests.
Overpayment Scams	Buyer sends a check for more than the purchase price, asking for the difference.	Verify checks before refunding any overpayment; report suspicious buyers.
Non-Delivery Scams	Payment taken but goods never shipped, seller unresponsive.	Use payment methods with buyer protection; research seller reputation.

the URL. If it doesn't match the expected destination, or if the email is unsolicited, don't click.

- **Use Secure Payment Methods:** When shopping online, use secure payment methods and avoid wire transfers to individuals you don't know.
- **Double-Check Website URLs:** Be wary of misspellings or unusual domain extensions in website URLs, which can indicate fake sites.

Reporting and Recovering from Online Fraud

If you suspect you've been the victim of online fraud, acting swiftly can help mitigate the damage and potentially recover lost funds.

Steps to Take if You're Scammed

Immediate actions can include:

- **Contact Your Bank or Credit Card Company:** Report the fraud and dispute any unauthorised transactions. Ask about blocking further transactions and reissuing your cards.
- **Change Your Passwords:** Immediately change passwords for any compromised accounts, especially if the same password is used across multiple sites.
- **Report to Cybercrime Portal:** File a complaint at the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (<https://cybercrime.gov.in/>) or call the National Cyber Crime Helpline (155260).
- **Gather Evidence:** Collect any emails, screenshots, or communication related to the fraudulent activity.
- **Report to Local Authorities:** Consider filing a police complaint, particularly for significant financial losses.
- **Credit Bureaus:** Contact Credit Information Companies

(CICs) like CIBIL, Experian, and Equifax to place fraud alerts on your credit reports.

Additional Resources for Help

Knowing where to turn for help can facilitate the recovery process:

- **FTC:** Offers a complaint assistant for reporting fraud and provides resources for dealing with various types of scams, particularly in the US jurisdiction.
- **Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3):** If the scam involves internet crime, such as online fraud, file a complaint with the IC3.
- **Credit Reporting Agencies:** Contact agencies to place fraud alerts on your credit reports, which can prevent identity theft.

Building a Support Network

Recovering from online fraud can be challenging. Building a support network of knowledgeable individuals and utilising resources can provide guidance and emotional support during the recovery process.

- **Engage with Online Communities:** Many online forums and communities offer advice and support for victims of online scams.
- **Consult Legal Advice:** If significant losses are involved, consulting with a legal professional specialising in cyber-crime might be beneficial.

By understanding how to avoid scams and the steps to take if fraud occurs, you can better protect yourself in the digital marketplace. This proactive and informed approach to online transactions and engagements can significantly enhance your security and resilience against the myriad threats present in the online world. 